

PRELUDE V

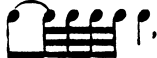
ONLY an exceptional technique or a hand capable of great stretch could execute this prelude *legatissimo* at a very rapid pace. Nor would the resulting *tour-de-force* be in any way better or more characteristic than a *leggiero*, bordering upon a finger-*staccato*, and admitting of some delicate special slurring, emphasis, or phrasing at such awkward corners as the end of bar 7 and other unexpected changes of position. All these were still more difficult on the clavichord than on the pianoforte. With such a *leggiero* touch (the basses as *pizzicato* as you please), and a lively but not precipitous *tempo*, it is easy to make a good climax by increasing the tone and becoming more *legato* when the bass A is held (from bar 27). There is no use in building up a climax any further back, for bars 20-25 are a recapitulation of bars 1-6 in the subdominant—a point that should not be obscured by any contrast of tone. From bar 30 the style becomes declamatory, and the rhythm should broaden in a cadenza-like manner to the big well-spread arpeggio in bar 33, over which a pause may be understood. The demisemiquavers (arising from the tied D, which should be well heard to sing by itself) must run brilliantly, with no broadening at the end, straight into the sharply broken chords of the next bar, which is to be understood as a typical (but not exaggerated) final *Adagio*. Both the quaver chords may be broken, but the rest of the close is in six real vocal parts.

It is very doubtful whether the bass-note of bar 33 should be A (as distinctly written in three autographs, and indistinctly in the fourth) or B as in the copies of pupils and in most printed editions. The pedal-point on A was deserted in bars 30-31, and has nothing to gain by revival here. The sound of the chord is in itself fine with A as bass, but B makes, with the following chords, an orderly progression of five steps in the bass from bar 30 to the middle of bar 34, and so gives due emphasis to the penultimate dominant when emphasis is required.

FUGUE V

THIS is a Fughetta without Countersubject or regular Stretto, the last appearance of the whole Subject being in a foreign key and little more than half-way through the composition. After this the Subject is represented only by its demisemiquaver figure, which should always culminate in an accent on the following upward skip (*e.g.*, the minim G in the alto of bar 20) instead of accenting the first note. The *tempo* should be about that of the introduction to a French Overture—*i.e.*, fast enough to make the demisemiquavers lively without confusion on a steady processional rhythmic background. The dotted notes are to be construed *in stile Francese* (as Bach says of Fugue VI. in *Die Kunst der Fuge*); that is to say, the value of the dot varies in a way that cannot be well represented by modernising the notation. Thus, the groups of three demisemi-

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quavers in bars 3, 6, 7, 8, 14, and 23, are never triplets, but are of the rhythmic type , so that the first note of the three must be entirely without accent. They need not, however, be as slow as ordinary demisemiquavers, nor in the present instance can they be as fast as , which, however, is theoretically a possible enough reading of the old notation. The one construction which is never admissible is the triplet. Again, the dotted quavers  vary according to their circumstances. The semiquaver will have its ordinary value when accompanied by semiquavers as in the Episodes, bars 9-10 and 17-19, or when the harmony demands this precise value, as in the second crotchet of bar 4; but elsewhere the tendency should be to sharpen the rhythmic jerk; and at the third crotchet of bar 22 the harmony imperatively calls for double dots (a notation Bach could not use, because Leopold Mozart had not yet invented it).

The arpeggio with short *appoggiatura*, given in brackets in bars 10 and 11, is the most probable interpretation of Bach's *Häkchen* in this passage; there being a natural tendency on the clavichord and harpsichord for the chords to break when thus approached.